

CREATING A SETTLED SYSTEMS CODE PLAYERS

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Summary

Characters may refer to provisions of the **Settled Systems Administrative Code** in their backstories, employment records, criminal histories, licenses, contracts, medical files, military service, or family history.

You do not need to write a complete law. Usually, you only need:

1. what the law regulates;
2. the relevant Administrative Title or chapter;
3. the public reason the law exists;
4. how it affected your character.

Exact section and clause numbers should be confirmed by the GM before becoming setting canon.

THE SAFEST WAY TO CITE A LAW

A complete citation uses this format:

A[TITLE] %[CHAPTER] & [SECTION] - [CLAUSE]

Example:

A2%13&1-3

This means:

- ♦ **A2** — Administrative Title 2
- ♦ **%13** — Chapter 13
- ♦ **&1** — Section 1
- ♦ **-3** — Clause 3

You may cite only the title or chapter when the exact provision has not been established.

Examples:

- ◆ Administrative Title 4
- ◆ Title Four labor regulations
- ◆ Settled Systems Code **A4%5**
- ◆ the workplace-safety provisions of **A4%5**
- ◆ a passenger-eligibility rule under **A5%8**

Player-Safe Rule

Using an established chapter stem without inventing a section or clause cannot conflict with an existing law.

Write **A4%5** during character creation. The GM can assign the complete citation later if one is needed.

STEP 1: DECIDE WHAT THE LAW ACTUALLY DOES

Choose the law's primary legal effect.

Ask which statement best describes it:

- ◆ It establishes who counts as a person.
- ◆ It verifies identity or maintains a record.
- ◆ It determines who owns something.
- ◆ It creates a debt or lease obligation.
- ◆ It regulates employment or compensation.
- ◆ It controls travel, cargo, docking, or relay use.
- ◆ It authorizes a search, detention, or security action.
- ◆ It regulates land, extraction, settlement, or environmental damage.
- ◆ It governs citizenship or government authority.
- ◆ It creates emergency powers or quarantine restrictions.

Use the title that governs this primary effect.

A law can interact with several titles. Choose one controlling title and treat the others as related provisions.

EXAMPLE

A company can repossess a leased cybernetic limb.

- ◆ The ownership and lease rule belongs under **A3**.
- ◆ A security provision authorizing forced entry would belong under **A6**.

◆ A medical-consent dispute might involve **A2**.

The backstory can mention all three without assigning three complete citations.

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLES

Titl e	Legal Field	Common Backstory Uses
A 0	Definitions, interpretation, jurisdiction, and general provisions	Legal definitions, jurisdiction disputes, conflicting laws; ask the GM before assigning a chapter
A 1	Standards, records, language, timekeeping, authentication, and interoperability	Missing records, stamp disputes, invalid licenses, incompatible equipment, disputed transmissions
A 2	Personhood, ancestry, identity, biology, medical status, and embodiment	Legal identity, ancestry registration, body modification, synthetic life, medical consent
A 3	Property, finance, leasing, debt, and ownership	Leased equipment, inherited debt, repossession, patents, ownership disputes
A 4	Labor, employment, wages, civic service, housing, and benefits	Employment contracts, unpaid labor, workplace injuries, company housing, Great Volunteering
A 5	Drift travel, transit, communications, navigation, docking, and relays	Ship registration, passenger clearance, cargo restrictions, docking bans, relay priority
A 6	Security, investigation, detention, enforcement, and closure	Arrests, searches, evidence, security authority, detention, criminal sentences
A 7	Extraction, environmental regulation, settlement, land, and resources	Mining rights, land claims, water use, environmental harm, settlement charters
A 8	Citizenship, government, jurisdiction, and intersystem agreements	Citizenship, local authority, political representation, foreign governments
A 9	Emergencies, disasters, evacuation, quarantine, and extraordinary powers	Evacuation orders, requisitioned labor, quarantine, emergency seizure of property

COMMON CHAPTER STEMS

Use these when one clearly fits the backstory.

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 1: STANDARDS AND RECORDS

Code Stem	Subject
A1%1	Records and Authentication

Code Stem	Subject
A1%2	Post-Erbium Standard and Stamp Authority
A1%5	Communication and Language Standards
A1%8	Technical Interoperability Requirements
A1%11	Relay Archives

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 2: PERSONHOOD AND EMBODIMENT

Code Stem	Subject
A2%1	Identity and Biological Continuity
A2%2	Legal Personhood and Sapience Recognition
A2%4	Ancestry Classification and Registration
A2%7	Bodily Modification and Medical Consent
A2%10	Biological Replication, Cloning, and Derivative Tissue
A2%13	Synthetic Persons and Manufactured Sapience

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 3: PROPERTY AND FINANCE

Code Stem	Subject
A3%1	General Property and Ownership
A3%4	Equipment and Component Leasing
A3%6	Intellectual and Biological Property
A3%8	Debt, Liability, and Surviving Obligations
A3%12	Asset Recovery and Repossession

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 4: LABOR AND SERVICE

Code Stem	Subject
A4%1	Employment Classification
A4%3	Wages, Compensation, and Service Credits
A4%5	Workplace Safety and Assumed Risk
A4%7	Benefits, Housing, and Service Eligibility

Code Stem	Subject
A4%9	Civic Service and Great Volunteering
A4%12	Employment Separation and Service Instability

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 5: TRANSIT AND COMMUNICATIONS

Code Stem	Subject
A5%1	Drift Vessel Registration
A5%3	Relay Access and Communication Priority
A5%6	Navigation Records and Stamp Compliance
A5%8	Passenger and Cargo Eligibility
A5%11	Docking, Transit, and Port Authority

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 6: SECURITY AND ENFORCEMENT

Code Stem	Subject
A6%1	Corporate and Civil Enforcement Authority
A6%4	Detention and Identity Verification
A6%6	Search, Seizure, and Evidence Control
A6%8	Closure Procedures
A6%11	Infrastructure and Resource Security Actions

Closure

Closure means a capital sentence and execution.

It does not mean termination of employment, deletion of a record, loss of benefits, disappearance, or administrative removal.

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 7: RESOURCES AND SETTLEMENT

Code Stem	Subject
A7%1	Resource Survey and Classification

Code Stem	Subject
A7%3	Extraction Licensing
A7%6	Environmental Risk and Remediation
A7%9	Territorial and Settlement Claims
A7%12	Non-Elect Habitation and Integration Review

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 8: GOVERNMENT AND CITIZENSHIP

Code Stem	Subject
A8%1	Citizenship and Civic Recognition
A8%4	Local Government Authority
A8%7	Intersystem Jurisdiction
A8%10	Political Representation
A8%13	Recognition of External Governments

ADMINISTRATIVE TITLE 9: EMERGENCY POWERS

Code Stem	Subject
A9%1	Emergency Declarations
A9%3	Evacuation and Continuity Personnel
A9%6	Infrastructure Preservation Powers
A9%8	Emergency Requisition and Service
A9%11	Quarantine and Movement Restriction

STEP 2: GIVE THE LAW A FORMAL NAME

Settled Systems laws usually have calm, administrative names.

Useful terms include:

- ◆ Continuity
- ◆ Eligibility
- ◆ Verification
- ◆ Allocation

- ◆ Responsible Use
- ◆ Public Safety
- ◆ Service
- ◆ Infrastructure
- ◆ Authentication
- ◆ Preservation
- ◆ Interoperability
- ◆ Stabilization
- ◆ Recognition
- ◆ Custodial
- ◆ Transitional
- ◆ Occupational
- ◆ Emergency

EXAMPLE NAMES

- ◆ **Dependent Housing Transitional Eligibility Standard**
- ◆ **Certified Equipment Custodial Responsibility Provision**
- ◆ **Passenger Continuity Verification Requirement**
- ◆ **Occupational Exposure Reporting Standard**
- ◆ **Emergency Infrastructure Service Allocation**
- ◆ **Recognized Settlement Water-Use Provision**

These are examples of naming style. They are not established laws.

STEP 3: GIVE IT A REASONABLE PUBLIC PURPOSE

Most laws claim to address a real administrative or safety problem.

Examples include:

- ◆ preventing identity theft;
- ◆ protecting life-support infrastructure;
- ◆ keeping navigation records compatible;
- ◆ ensuring hazardous equipment receives maintenance;
- ◆ preserving access to emergency housing;
- ◆ preventing contamination;
- ◆ coordinating evacuations;
- ◆ establishing financial responsibility;

- ◆ keeping dangerous cargo off passenger vessels;
- ◆ determining which government has jurisdiction.

A law can serve a legitimate purpose and still harm people through cost, access, enforcement, or exemptions.

STEP 4: DECIDE HOW IT AFFECTED YOUR CHARACTER

Useful backstory consequences include:

- ◆ Your family inherited an obligation attached to property or equipment.
- ◆ You lost housing when a parent's employment ended.
- ◆ A record error made you ineligible for travel.
- ◆ Your medical procedure required corporate authorization.
- ◆ You were classified as an independent contractor and denied employee benefits.
- ◆ Your settlement lost a land, water, or extraction claim.
- ◆ Your identity was placed under review.
- ◆ You performed emergency or civic service.
- ◆ Your ship was detained over a registry discrepancy.
- ◆ You were blamed for equipment certified by someone else.
- ◆ You received protection through a law that others regularly abuse.
- ◆ Your community relied on an exemption that was later revoked.
- ◆ A local official helped you appeal an unfair application.
- ◆ Your employer followed the law exactly and still left you with the cost.

STEP 5: LEAVE THE EXACT NUMBER OPEN

Section and clause numbers are permanent registry assignments. They do not identify the law's date, severity, ancestry, penalty, or author.

Do not choose a number because it looks meaningful.

During character creation, write:

My family lost its housing under a transitional eligibility provision in Settled Systems Code **A4%7** .
The exact clause is pending GM confirmation.

Or:

My character was detained under an identity-verification provision of A6%4 .

Or:

The accident was governed by workplace-safety and assumed-risk rules under A4%5 .

The GM can assign the complete citation after checking the current Code Register.

EXISTING CITATIONS

The following citations already have established meanings and should never be reassigned:

Citation	Established Subject
A1%5&99-101	Adoption of Wander Slant as a foundation of Common
A2%1&4-13	Continuity-node interference, masking, removal, or falsification
A2%13&1-3	Exclusive android authority to assemble new androids
A4%9&1-1440	Wage ineligibility during designated Great Volunteering
A4%9&4-7	Vuddarian Cultural Sanctuary Exemption

This is not a complete list of every law used in the setting. The GM’s current Code Register is authoritative.

WRITING STYLE

A Settled Systems law usually sounds calm, technical, and impersonal.

APPROPRIATE

The provision establishes continued habitation eligibility during a verified period of employment separation.

Certified operators must preserve inspection records needed to establish responsible maintenance.

Passenger access may be suspended until continuity verification is restored.

AVOID

Erbium can throw workers into space whenever it wants.

This law lets the corporation steal your body.

Anyone who breaks this rule disappears forever.

The practical result may resemble those statements. The official wording should describe safety, continuity, eligibility, verification, infrastructure protection, or responsible administration.

QUICK BACKSTORY TEMPLATE

Copy and complete this section:

PROPOSED BACKSTORY LAW

What happened to my character or their family?

[One or two sentences.]

What does the law regulate?

[Employment, identity, property, travel, security, settlement, emergency powers, etc.]

Primary legal effect:

[What the law actually requires, permits, recognizes, or prohibits.]

Suggested title or chapter:

[**A#** or **A#%#**]

Proposed formal name:

[Technical and institutionally neutral title.]

Public purpose:

[Why authorities say the law is necessary.]

Practical effect:

[What happened to ordinary people or to the character.]

Who administered it?

[Employer, local government, registry, port authority, court, medical provider, security office, etc.]

Possible exception or appeal:

[Optional.]

Exact citation:

[Pending GM confirmation.]

COMPACT EXAMPLE

My mother worked as a pressure technician aboard an Erbium-operated habitat. After an injury ended her employment, our family received only a short period to transfer our housing eligibility.

Suggested chapter: A4%7 — Benefits, Housing, and Service Eligibility

Proposed law: *Pressure-Rated Housing Transitional Eligibility Standard*

Public purpose: Ensuring every occupied unit has a responsible operator and funded life-support service

Practical effect: Our family had thirty days to find a new sponsor, employer, or residence

Exact citation: Pending GM confirmation

 **Tip**

A good backstory law creates a specific pressure, obligation, protection, dispute, or relationship.

It should give your character something to care about during play: a debt, an appeal, a missing record, a former supervisor, a protected relative, an expired exemption, a legal enemy, or someone who once helped them.